

Speaker 1: Yes, welcome again and thank you very much for joining this call. As we mentioned on the message we sent, we are interested in your views on romantic relationships. We would like to know more about it and we believe that your experience and your perspective will be very helpful for the project. Is it okay for me to record this interview before we start? We will only use this recording for transcription and notation.

Speaker 1: It is appropriate.

Speaker 1: How old are you?

Speaker 2: [26-30].

Speaker 1: How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2: [6-10] years.

Speaker 1: Do you have children?

Speaker 2: No.

Speaker 1: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2: Normally, I live with my roommate in [City A], because I continue my education.

Speaker 1: What is your main source of income and your current job?

Speaker 2: My current job is a [Job] at the university.

Speaker 1: How should I address your partner? Girlfriend, wife, lover, partner.

Speaker 2: It doesn't matter, lover partner.

Speaker 1: Okay. Can you tell me the story of how you met your lover and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2: We were both in a community doing a social responsibility project. [City A] volunteer team at school. It is a community that aims to go to children in slum neighborhoods and be a role model for them. The [1st-5th] year we were just friends and we didn't see each other much anyway. In the [1st-5th] year, when I was still in the community, this time I took a higher position in the community, I mean I became the manager of the region I was in. She was actually one of my assistants. And at that time I had the opportunity to get to know her more. And as I got to know her more in this process, something started to develop over time.

Speaker 1: And if I could get more details about how your relationship developed?

Speaker 2: As I said, I knew her in the [1st-5th] year. We were actually in the same area, in the same community. Usually the community only met on Saturdays and we spent that day together. In that period, there was no such situation, we were just like friends. And I can even say that I liked someone else. So during that one year it was like a person I only knew a little bit from a distance. The next year, when I took a more active role, I can say that I brought her to an active role. We took part in the [position] of that region together for a while. In this process, we had the opportunity to get to know each other more and more and finally I realized that I felt something. And I explained it to her. At first she was a bit hesitant and said that she saw me as a friend. So she said she wanted to continue as friends for a while. Then I said okay, but we

continued to talk again in this process. And gradually, as we talked, she started to feel something for me, too. And eventually our relationship started.

Speaker 1: So how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to the quality of your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2: I can say high. Speaker 1: Good. So we have a lot in common in many ways. We get along well and we are understanding of each other. At the same time, we respect each other's boundaries without interfering too much.

Speaker 1: Would you like to explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2: I mean, because I think having common interests, common goals, common objectives is valuable for it to work in the long run. We can agree on this point. We both have goals in life. Apart from that, being understanding, being tolerant, being able to communicate is the most important thing. And respecting each other's boundaries is also important. Because, you know, for me, as a person who attaches importance to individuality, I actually like to have a wide area of freedom. Therefore, it is important for me that my partner respects this. Also, I am not a person who can put the relationship completely at the center of my life. It's more like I can't do it with such a person. That's why a person who has their own goals and objectives and who is moving forward on this path but who also wants to be a companion on this path is a more suitable partner for me. In this sense, I think my partner is ideal.

Speaker 1: And can I ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2: So there was one before this as a long relationship.

Speaker 1: How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationship?

Speaker 2: I mean, it will be a bit difficult to compare because it was a relationship in high school and when it just started, it was very nice, of course, a lot of things. But it was in high school and then when we started university, going to different cities started to wear the situation a little bit. Other than that, there were more issues we didn't agree on. I mean, there were more points where our ideas didn't match. We had less in common.

Speaker 1: So in terms of quality, if you had to make a comparison, what would you say?

Speaker 2: Maybe the excitement and enthusiasm at the beginning was more because it was the first time and I was in high school. But it wore out faster over time and then it started to become a challenging factor rather than a quality relationship. So I would say it was lower in quality.

Speaker 1: Actually, you mentioned a little bit before. But I would like to ask you again. What are the things that make a relationship a high quality one for you?

Speaker 2: The most important thing is that both of you have a life purpose and have goals for yourself. Because otherwise, when you just put someone at the center of your life, it's much more difficult to make things work, I mean, if someone makes me the center of their life, it would probably create a lot more responsibility and pressure on me. So it's about both sides having that space of freedom, having their own goals and objectives. At the same time, being tolerant

and understanding towards each other and being able to communicate. And enjoying spending time together, having things in common, that's basically it. And of course trust.

Speaker 1: Let me ask you why do you think so, for these factors that you mentioned and why do you think the relationship is of good quality?

Speaker 2: As I said, when both sides have their own goals, objectives and expectations, we wear out the other side less. And not piling expectations on the other side at this point actually makes the process work healthier. Apart from that, communication is the basis of everything. Therefore, when you can establish a healthy communication, when the other party listens to you and tries to understand you, which is true for all relationships, you progress in a healthier way. And problems are solved. Otherwise, problems start to accumulate and lead to bigger problems. But when you can communicate and solve them, it is much more beneficial in the long run. Apart from that, the understanding and toleration. Of course trust. So these are probably the most fundamental things.

Speaker 1: What makes a relationship low quality for you?

Speaker 2: I mean, a restrictive jealousy, for example. Apart from that, interfering too much in someone's freedom. Not communicating, that is, waiting for the other person to understand instead of saying what bothers them. Instead of communicating, for example, sulking. In other words, instead of communicating and telling about a problem, it is more unhealthy to create a problem about it.

Speaker 1: Why is that? I'm sorry, I'm repeating myself a little bit, but I need to explain these concepts a little bit more. Why do you think that these characteristics reduce the quality, the quality in the relationship?

Speaker 2: I mean a jealousy that is meaningless and restricts the freedom of the person. So it actually prevents that person from being themselves. Not being able to do the things they want, feeling under pressure when they do, or having to lie. This already carries the relationship to a very unhealthy point. Therefore, it prevents people from being themselves in the first place. Secondly, of course, lying or being put in that situation is something that negatively affects the mutual trust between the two parties. Apart from that, when there is a problem, making it a problem instead of sharing it and communicating and persisting with the logic of letting the other party understand, again makes some problems bigger than necessary and makes them unsolvable. I mean, frankly, these seem a bit like cultural approaches to me. You know, instead of talking about these problems, "sulking", waiting for the other party to understand is a bit like something that culture has taught us. So it seems meaningless to me.

Speaker 1: So would you say that for you a high quality relationship is one in which there is a space for freedom, a relationship in which everyone has their own boundaries, as you put it, and both parties have different goals in life?

Speaker 2: So this is one of the criteria. Of course, besides that, it is not enough of course. The other things that I have described are communicating, being understanding, tolerant, enjoying spending time together, being a good friend at the same time.

Speaker 1: So, how can one know that a person is in a relationship with strong communication? Can you tell us more about that?

Speaker 2: So is this understanding from my point of view or for the two people I'm looking at from the outside?

Speaker 1: I mean, how do you, frankly, conceptualize it? I mean, in a relationship, when I say how can a person understand, you can give an example from your own relationship or I want to ask you frankly according to your understanding, which is valid for you.

Speaker 2: I mean, basically, like I said, when there is something that makes you feel uncomfortable, to share it openly. To express it openly to your partner, instead of building things up in your head about it. This was the first one. The second is to try to understand the other person's feelings rather than perceiving it as an accusation when someone expresses it to you in this way, for example, when your partner expresses it to you. Again, a strong communication actually requires this. Otherwise going directly into defense mode, thinking that the other party is actually blaming you, again leads to an unhealthy communication. Therefore, the first one is to express the problems openly to the other party, the feelings, the problems, openly to the other party. You know, sharing this directly with the other party and letting him/her know those feelings and emotions instead of going forward by reading or thinking about intentions in your head. Trying to find out what he/she thinks about it, seeing it as a sharing rather than perceiving it as an accusation when a partner comes with such a feeling, and trying to understand why the other party feels this way, what he/she feels.

Speaker 1: When would you say that your relationship has strong communication, or rather healthy communication, as you call it.

Speaker 2: When do you mean when?

Speaker 1: So let me ask you like this, when was it too much and when was it too little. Can you give examples of healthy communication?

Speaker 2: I mean, the first beginning, of course, became healthier over time. Because after mutual feedbacks. You know, it is something that changes a little bit from time to time, frankly. But for example, in some conversations, in some discussions, I realized that I was constantly in defense mode on my own behalf. Instead of trying to understand the other side, taking it as an accusation and going directly into defense mode. At this point, for example, I received feedback from the other side and then it started to become healthier. But when she says something like that to me, how does it make me feel? When she tried to understand this, it started to become healthier again. Of course, there were some problems in the past that we didn't talk about openly. But later, when we started talking about them, it became healthier again. So maybe we were communicating incorrectly for [1-5] years, especially after we started. But especially in the last [1-5] years, it has become healthier. Of course, there was also a period when we were away due to the pandemic. Here again, it had become a bit unhealthy.

Speaker 1: You touched a little bit on these in your previous answers. But I would like to follow up with you again if it's okay with you. What are the most important things for you in a relationship?

Speaker 2: I mean, as I said, of course both sides should have their own goals. But at the same time, if you want to walk a path together, then both sides have to sacrifice more or less at the same time. Therefore, both sides should have their own goals and objectives. But also to have a

thought system that can make sacrifices for the other side when necessary. Proper communication, understanding, tolerance. So basically the things I said.

Speaker 1: Would you like to explain a little bit more why you say that? These concepts.

Speaker 2: I mean, as I said, it is important that both sides have their own goals and objectives. But in today's world, being able to achieve this while walking on the same path requires sacrifice. Therefore, in order to stay in a relationship, this is inevitable for a long-term relationship. In other words, both sides need to stretch their limits in many factors such as moving to a new place, choosing a place to live, choosing a lifestyle. But at the same time, it is also valuable not to lose being oneself. Therefore, both these sacrifices and respecting the boundaries of the other party. And staying in constant communication seems to be the most important factor for it to last.

Speaker 1: So what is love for you?

Speaker 2: So a little bit of love (sevgi), a little bit of passion, a little bit of wanting the other person, maybe sexually. It's like a situation where these things are together. So it involves a little bit of love (sevgi). It can also be a desire to be one, to be one for the other person. At the same time, feeling sexually attracted to the other person. It's probably something like a situation where these are in harmony.

Speaker 1: How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2: So in the beginning of course it is important. But over time, some of these things may diminish. In this case, I feel like love (sevgi) is more important, factors such as love (sevgi) and commitment are more important, because I feel like love (aşk) is a feeling that can come and go and settle down. So of course it is valuable to have these feelings in the beginning. But afterwards, when it gradually fades away, you have to realize that there is no problem. Because it is natural for it to diminish, but the important thing is love (sevgi).

Speaker 1: So how do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2: So in the small details, seeing that she actually thinks about me, seeing that she cares about me, seeing that she worries about me from time to time. Seeing that she care about what I say and she tries to do something about it, she makes sacrifices from time to time. Like I said, it's something like she thinks about the little details about me and actually takes action by making sacrifices when necessary, or she worries about me.

Speaker 1: Can you give an example of some of these concepts?

Speaker 2: I mean, when I tell that I feel bad, for example, when she tries to make me feel good when she calls or comes to me immediately on the day I feel bad, or when she tries to distract me. Or for example, if I give an example from myself, there is a situation like a panic attack, an anxiety attack that I experience while traveling. She constantly thinks about it and comes to me with new solutions. I mean, while I sometimes don't even think about it anymore, she thinks constantly and comes up with things like let's try this, let's try that, and at the same time helping me with these things can be given as an example. Or when I'm sick, she worries about me and tells me to do this and do that, even if she can't be with me. So when she's with me, she already takes care of me.

Speaker 1: What would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2: I mean, the most important thing is that there are of course uncertainties when drawing a long path together. For example, when I want to pursue an academic career abroad, when I go abroad. There is a warning about the remaining time.

Speaker 1: Yes. Let's finish this question if you like. Let's open a new session after that. If it is convenient for you, please go ahead. You were talking about abroad.

Speaker 2: For example, when I get a PhD acceptance from somewhere. Will my partner be able to get a doctorate from a similar place? If so, will we be able to live together? Or will it continue far away? These uncertainties are of course challenging. I mean, having a distant relationship is challenging in every way. From time to time, some small jealousy situations can be challenging. Here again, good communication is actually a solution. Other than that, there is actually nothing very challenging. Maybe I can also say another thing. I mean, inevitably, the feelings one experiences at first are very nice and one wants to experience them again and again. Then maybe there are times when one wants to have new experiences. But getting into a relationship means giving these up a little bit. And this can be challenging at some point.

Speaker 1: And do you fight with your lover?

Speaker 2: Sometimes. Yes. I mean, not very violent, but there are times when we argue.

Speaker 1: How often? You said sometimes.

Speaker 2: It depends actually. But maybe once a month or once every [1-5] months. I don't know right now, it changes a lot.

Speaker 1: What are these fights or arguments about?

Speaker 2: One of the main reasons is that I don't spend enough time with her, I don't pay enough attention to her. According to her. Another one can be small jealousy-based things. I mean, mostly from her, let me put it this way. These arguments start mostly from her side. But they probably start because of things I do or don't do. So when I don't draw enough boundaries for people, this can lead to some jealousy situations. Secondly, as I said, when she thinks that I don't spend enough time with her, that I'm not interested in her.

Speaker 1: So how do you solve these fights?

Speaker 2: So when she comes to me with something like this, I usually go into a defensive mode first, and that leads to both sides speaking more harshly after a while. But at the end of the day, when one of us approaches it in a more constructive way, it is solved by communicating and trying to understand each other's feelings and agreeing to change them if there is something we need to change.

Speaker 1: Let's stop here if you like. I will be sharing with you via Whatsapp with a new link, thank you very much. See you soon. I am stopping the recording.

Speaker 1: Yes, okay, we are recording. If you want to continue, we had a break for questions.

Speaker 2: Sure.

You can hear it right now, right?

Speaker 2: I can hear... Okay, I'll close this window and come this way

Speaker 1: I can wait. Okay, I'm stopping the recording.

Speaker 1: Yes, it's actually going on as part two now. In the previous question I wanted to know a little bit about your fights and you mentioned that you resolve them through communication and understanding feelings. Other than that, what are some other ways of maintaining your relationship?

Speaker 2: I mean, of course it is necessary to make time for each other, to find activities that we enjoy together. Apart from that, you know, the things I said before are already necessary for a relationship to be good. Besides that, thinking about the other side while doing something. Communicating is always the most basic anyway. As I said, making time for the other party. So taking care of his/her problems. Doing activities that you enjoy together on a regular basis. These are important.

Speaker 1: So would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2: Yes, I can.

Speaker 1: Why?

Speaker 2: I mean, I feel that the other person understands me, my partner understands me, cares about me, loves (sevdigini) me. I feel the same way about her. And she is someone I enjoy spending time with. Someone I would like to see as a companion in the long term. So I would say it's good.

Speaker 1: Can you give some more examples? About these?

Speaker 2: My partner has always supported me in many difficult situations. As I said, I have been through it before. She always tried to find solutions to some psychological problems. She tried to help me, which actually made very important contributions. You know, along with offering me a solution, she actually did things from time to time to encourage me to take that step. She took action. It is already a long-term relationship and now you know, we can foresee many things. We can easily get along. Even when there is an argument, we can easily overcome mutual problems by being constructive. Our expectations about life are close, in other words, they are on a parallel and linear plane. Our life expectations are not very different. Therefore. So that's it.

Speaker 1: Actually you mentioned a couple of times about being comrades. Together. Can you elaborate on this a little bit? I will ask you to give an example.

Speaker 2: So. As we walk towards our goals and objectives in life. You know, relationship is one of the important parts of life. But also when we walk on other paths, when we walk to other

goals. Having the support of someone you love behind you is valuable at many points. And in the long run, a companion always feels like a necessity in life. I mean, of course, this is something that can vary from person to person, but it is valuable for me to have someone like that, someone who you know will be there for me in difficult situations. I have already experienced this so far. Therefore. I mean, when I want to achieve my goals in the long run, while walking towards my goals. Or when I continue my life, it is important to have a person who supports me and who I enjoy being with.

Speaker 1: So has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2: In some issues, yes, I mean, it's a little bit difficult to say this because this is an age where there are already big changes due to my age. So I don't know how much of this I should attribute to the relationship, but I can say that I started to communicate better. I can say that I learned to draw my boundaries more. I mean, I used to have problems setting boundaries with other people, but during my relationship I learned to do this more in line with some demands of my partner. Other than that, I guess these are the most basic changes.

Speaker 1: So do you think your partner changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2: There were points where she also changed. Yes, there were some points where we disagreed. I mean, she actually expanded some of his boundaries compared to the beginning of the relationship. You know, some of the boundaries she drew could be a problem for me. There were points where we both disagreed at that point. But both she expanded her boundaries a little bit and I expanded my boundaries a little bit. I mean, for example, regarding jealousy, I learned to draw boundaries for people a little bit more. She started to understand me a little bit more in this process. It's like we both somehow came to a middle point. At many points, she has also changed in many ways in terms of herself.

Speaker 1: Is the person you were before the relationship the same person you are now?

Speaker 2: I mean, I'm not exactly the same, but have a great deal of similarities. But I can't talk about a very big change, but I can't say that I'm exactly the same person.

Speaker 1: Why do you think that you are not the same person?

Speaker 2: I mean, I think I am more mature now, I think I can draw my boundaries more clearly. And I look to the future with more certainty. In the past, there were more question marks for me. I never knew what I expected from a relationship. But now, at least many things are more predictable for me about a relationship. Apart from that, as I said, I learned to draw my boundaries more in my personal sense. I learned to be a better communicator.

Speaker 1: I'm going to ask the same question about your partner. Do you think your partner is the same now as he/she was before the relationship?

Speaker 2: Not she either. As I said, she has also expanded some of her boundaries and while she used to have more conservative thoughts on some issues, now she thinks much differently, I mean, I can say that she thinks much more open-minded on many points, at least on some points, not necessarily on many points.

Speaker 1: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes I feel

Speaker 1: Could you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2: Because I have seen that my partner has always been with me in the most difficult situations. Apart from that, we have never experienced a situation that would raise a question mark about trust. So at this point, yes, we are safe. I have complete trust in her and I feel safe in the relationship.

Speaker 1: Can you give some examples of moments when you felt safe?

Speaker 2: I mean, I saw that she was always with me in many difficult situations. I saw that she always supported me on my way to my goals. Apart from that, she has always made me feel her love and trust and she has never done anything to shake my trust. In this sense, I feel safe. And I can be sure from her statements and behaviors that she always wants to walk this path with me in the long run.

Speaker 1: I actually want to visualize my next question a little bit, so that it will be easier for you to answer. I'm going to ask you for a second and I'm going to share a screen, can you see it?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: If I ask you that your parties usually really listen to me, between one not at all true and nine completely true, which one do you think is appropriate?

Speaker 2: Seven.

Speaker 1: Okay. Do you see the screen now?

Speaker 2: No.

Speaker 1: Okay. Now I'm going to share again. So if I ask you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, which one would you say is appropriate?

Speaker 2: Six.

Speaker 1: Yes. You gave the answer of seven for the parties usually really listen to me. I will ask you why you think seven is appropriate.

Speaker 2: I mean, sometimes I actually undecided between seven or eight because I can say that she listens in general, of course there were points where I was not understood at the beginning of the relationship. That's why I don't give nine anyway. I mean, in general, I always feel that I am listened to, at least I feel that she is trying to understand me. Of course, there were times when I felt that she did not understand at some points. So here, maybe my expectations were too high or I wasn't fully understood, so I wasn't sure, but it's between seven and eight for me.

Speaker 1: So can you give concrete examples of when these things happen?

Speaker 2: I mean, I think in general, I mean, at the beginning of the relationship, I mean, both of us, for example, in terms of our attitudes towards the outside, she was more conservative while I was more sociable. And this could lead to problems like jealousy from time to time. At this point, we understood each other's limits by listening to each other. And at that point I felt that she was trying to understand me.

Speaker 1: So why seven and not six or eight?

Speaker 2: So it's not six, it's seven or eight for me anyway. Six seems low, so it might be something unfair. I'm not sure if it's as high as eight, but actually there's not much difference between seven and eight. I guess if I really have to say something, it's the fact that it's written very accurately under seven. Otherwise I don't see a clear difference between seven and eight. You know, the reason why it's not a nine is, as I said, of course, there were points where I felt that I was not understood from time to time.

Speaker 1: When I asked you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, you said [6-10] years. I will ask you again why you think six is appropriate.

Speaker 2: Maybe I should have called it seven, I'm not sure. In fact, it seems more accurate to say seven now. I mean, there were periods in the beginning of the relationship when she could have been more sensitive. In the current relationship, I would say between seven and eight. I mean, as an average, maybe there were points where I was not sure whether she saw my needs at some points before or not.

Speaker 1: So can you give us some examples of when this happened, again I will ask you the same question?

Speaker 2: I mean, again, in the middle of the relationship, maybe a little bit more because we both have a different understanding of socialization and the way we communicate with people outwardly. You know, there may have been some jealousy problems. I mean, apart from that, maybe at the beginning, our sexual expectations were different and this was solved again in the process. But at that point in the beginning, there were times when I felt that my needs were not fully met, even if I wouldn't say insensitive in quotation marks.

Speaker 1: And why? I mean, I don't know what to say right now to be honest. The last thing, I'm still basing the scoring on six or seven whatever you want.

Speaker 2: It could be seven actually.

Speaker 1: All right. I will ask you why you have decided on seven and not six or eight.

Speaker 2: I mean because I actually think it's quite responsive at the moment. Maybe there were times in the past when I didn't feel it was that responsive, so eight seemed a bit too high. But six would also be unfair in the current situation. So that's why I think at least seven.

Speaker 1: I hope you don't mind asking the next question. Because you mentioned earlier that sex is important in a relationship. If this is a sensitive topic for you to share, please feel free to say so. But I would also like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple, if that's okay with you. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2: I mean, we have been separated for a long time, we are far away. So we haven't had for a long time, because we haven't met. I mean, we had the opportunity to meet in [City B], but there she was staying at his family's house. I was staying at a hotel. The last time he came to [City A], it was a while ago. It must have been a couple of months.

Speaker 1: And how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2: At this point it is like this. Now, I don't have much of a problem whether to answer this question but my partner may not want to answer them. But you know, from her point of view, so I don't know what to say, but for myself, I mean, it can be called a little above average. Six seven out of ten.

Speaker 1: I would like to ask you actually respecting the boundaries of your partnership. And if it is a problem for you, as I said, feel free to say so. Don't feel obliged to answer. But I mean, let me ask and you can answer this question if you wish. I wanted to ask if you would like to explain a little bit more why you say that.

Speaker 2: I think for me, basically, I think a little bit in retrospect, I would like to have more experiences before I get into a long relationship, because after a certain point that physical desire inevitably diminishes. Therefore, my dissatisfaction stems a little bit from this. So either way, I think it's normal for it to decrease in a relationship in [6-10] years. But sometimes I sometimes think that it would have been better for me if I had more experience in this regard before, and at this point it would have been better for me to start a relationship in a saturated way.

Speaker 1: Again, I am going to ask you with a visual, so I am sharing a screen, I hope you can see it now.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: How satisfied are you with your relationship in general?

Speaker 2: Very pleased.

Speaker 1: Okay. So in this question, when I ask you again how do you rate your satisfaction with your relationship, between 0 being not satisfied at all and 10 being completely satisfied, which one would you prefer?

Speaker 2: 8

Speaker 1: I'm going to stop the screen sharing again. Yes, actually I'm going to be coming back to you with the same question, why did you answer eight?

Speaker 2: Because I am very satisfied in many ways. I think she is an ideal person for me. So it is not a relationship that I would give less than 7. Not 7 either. Because I feel that I am understood at many points. I feel that I can communicate. She is a person I enjoy being with. Not 9-10 either. Because as I said, I like to be a little bit more independent, sometimes a lot. At this point, there are times when I want to feel very independent. I like the idea of feeling like a single individual and being independent and free. And the idea of being dependent on someone can sometimes be a bit scary for me. Apart from that, I can say that I have some dissatisfaction with the past. You know, both sexually and in terms of experience. So maybe I can't say 9-10.

Speaker 1: So did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2: I mean, for the most part, yes, in some points, it is better than I expected. Of course, there are points where it does not meet.

Speaker 1: Would you like to elaborate a little bit more if that's okay with you?

Speaker 2: I mean, on many points, you know, the other side being understanding, respecting my boundaries. It is very good that we have such a good communication. Apart from that, of course, that initial passion, desire, attraction decreases over time. You don't expect such a thing at first. I mean, even if you know, it's not like an expectation at the beginning. Therefore, this decreases over time. In the physical sense, that attraction decreases over time. You know, these are things that don't meet my expectations after a certain point.

Speaker 1: Yes, we are about to conclude our discussion. I would like to summarize what we talked about for the last hour, if that's okay with you. You are [26-30] years old. You live with your friend. And you met your boyfriend through a social responsibility project at the university. At first you were undecided about this situation. After that, you actually talked about a relationship that started with friendship. And the important qualities for you in the relationship and the qualities that make it high quality. Having a life purpose and goal on both sides separately. But to be comrades together at the same time. You talked about tolerance, communication and actually understanding. You talked about the things that make a relationship of low quality, you talked about the restrictive situations, the jealousy, the interference with the limits of freedom. And you described love for you as a combination of love, sexual desire and passion, you know, a combination and a state of harmony. You talked about love being more important in the beginning and then a relationship that can actually settle down with love and commitment. And you mentioned that your parties pay attention to small details to know that they love you, that they worry about you, that they care about what you say. And again you talked about resolving some conflicts through communication and the importance of making time for each other and doing enjoyable activities together outside of this communication. And you mentioned that you changed a little bit together, you mentioned that you are not the same person, but you mentioned that your character is also shaped by the things you have experienced due to your age. Apart from that, yes, was what I mentioned true, is there anything you would like to add? I would like to ask you these last questions.

Speaker 2: What you mentioned was correct.

Speaker 1: How comfortable did you feel talking about these things? I would like to ask you about that.

Speaker 2: Generally this is during this conversation from the very beginning?

Speaker 1: Yes, I mean in general, how comfortable did you feel during the interview?

Speaker 2: I mean, I felt comfortable, in fact, some of the questions were challenging. I mean, most of them were things that I had thought about before during this relationship, so I didn't feel very uncomfortable while answering most of them. I mean, sometimes I didn't know what to say or I wasn't sure how to make the evaluation on that scale. But other than that, I can't say I felt uncomfortable. There were moments when I had difficulty in guessing the answers to the questions, but other than that I felt comfortable.

Speaker 1: Okay. Thank you very much again. Now, before we finish, I actually mentioned at the beginning of the interview, I would like to talk to you about how you will separate the data. As a research project, we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. Therefore, I would like you to decide which data sharing option is most suitable for you. Now your first option is to share parts of the transcript of the interview. None of these transcripts will contain any information that can identify you. This way your de-identified interview transcript can be read by

other researchers. The second option, if you do not mind and if you want to be a little more daring, is to share the entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, in other words, de-anonymized. In this option, there is still a very, very small chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the options for who they believe you are among their colleagues. And again, I want to emphasize that no sensitive information about you will be shared in either option. Which of these two options do you prefer?

Speaker 2: Okay, the second one is also okay.

Speaker 1: Okay, thank you very much again. I would like you to know that this study has also been done in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France and the USA. In order for this study to be successful, there is actually one last request that I would like to ask you, if it's okay with you. Could you suggest two close people in your life as candidates? We will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this study. We will also ask them to suggest couples that you do not know and have not interacted with, so that we can reach as diverse a population of participants as possible. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker 2: Of course I can suggest. I mean, I don't know if they want

Speaker 1: Thank you very much. Then thank you very much and I will stop the recording here unless there is anything you would like to add.

Speaker 2: No thank you.

Speaker 1: All right. Good afternoon.